

RetailzPOS / Moolah Points — Daily Trending Topics Brief

October 6, 2026

Trending now — 6 topics with a genuine brand angle

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
1	The NACS Show is live — general session and kick-off party today (Oct 6), with the full expo floor and “Cool New Products Preview Room” opening tomorrow (Oct 7) in Las Vegas.	Orbital — The NACS Show 2026	Instagram/LinkedIn, buyer-checklist repost. Not a booth pitch — a genuinely useful “walking the floor tomorrow?” post: 4 questions worth asking any POS vendor before signing anything (live demo of the age-verification block, exact swipe-fee breakdown, data portability if you switch later, SMS compliance for age-restricted marketing). Pulled straight from the buyer checklists already built into our comparison blogs — repurposed for show season, not written from scratch.

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
2	The largest-ever academic study on self-checkout shrink just landed — stores with self-checkout post losses 33% higher than staffed-lane stores, with the gap showing up in year one; Target, Walmart, and Sam’s Club are all scaling self-checkout back.	Beancount — Self-Checkout Shrinkage 2026: ECR Report & Loss Prevention Guide	Instagram/LinkedIn, compliance-angle post. Not a general shrink post — the sharper point for liquor/smoke-vape/CBD retailers: “Self-checkout shrink is already measurably higher than staffed lanes. Now picture that same gap on an age-restricted sale nobody actually verified — that’s not a few dollars of loss, that’s a license on the line.” Security/compliance education, no pricing claims, no self-checkout product pitch.
3	New tariffs are cascading through the three-tier alcohol system — a 10–15% border tariff on imported spirits gets marked up again at the importer, distributor, and retailer level, so it can land as a 15–25% shelf-price increase by the time it reaches the register.	Vinetur — Trump’s New Tariffs Hit Imported Alcohol With Uneven Costs	LinkedIn, margin-by-origin post. A sharper version of “costs are rising”: “A 15% tariff on an EU import doesn’t stay 15% by the time it’s on your shelf — the three-tier system marks it up twice more. The useful question isn’t ‘how do I absorb this,’ it’s ‘which SKUs on my shelf are even exposed’ — EU, UK, and USMCA-origin products aren’t affected the same way. Know that before your next order, not from the invoice.”

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
4	Oral nicotine is surging — and the tax map just shifted under it. Convenience-store smokeless/nicotine-pouch sales are up 12.2% year-over-year to \$13.5B, while South Carolina’s first-ever vape excise tax took effect Oct 1 and New York extended its tobacco tax to nicotine pouches on Sept 1.	Tobacco Insider — USA: Nicotine Pouches	Instagram/LinkedIn carousel for smoke/vape retailers. Plain, factual: “Nicotine pouches are one of the fastest-growing categories at the counter right now — and two states just changed how they’re taxed (SC, effective Oct 1; NY, effective Sept 1). If pouches are a growing line on your shelf, the tax math on that SKU probably isn’t what it was in August.” Pure compliance-education, state-specific, no health or usage claims.
5	New 2026 loyalty research: shoppers enroll in 8 programs but actively use only 5, and patience for slow, deferred rewards is gone — while SMBs running loyalty programs are seeing real revenue lift (23.93% loyalty-driven growth in one dataset).	Marsello — What Customers Actually Want From a Loyalty Program in 2026	Instagram/LinkedIn, Moolah Points post. “Your regulars are in 8 loyalty programs and only bother with 5 of them. The ones that survive the cut aren’t the ones with the biggest multiplier — they’re the ones that don’t make someone wait six months to feel like it mattered. That’s the actual case for a loyalty program built for one store, not a national chain’s point-hoarding scheme.” No specific offer stated, value-of-approach framing only.

#	Trend	Source	Brand-twist content idea
6	Instagram’s “This or That” carousel format — two-option choice slides, currently outperforming single-image posts by 114% and trending specifically because the algorithm now weights swipe-through and per-slide dwell time.	Stack Influence — What Are Instagram Carousels? 2026 Guide	Instagram carousel, format-jack. A 3-slide “This or That” built from pain points already established in our content library: “Carding every regular from memory” vs. “one scan, logged automatically” / “Counting the drawer by hand” vs. “automated close-out” / “Guessing what’s low in the cooler” vs. “a live stock alert.” No new claims — just repackaging what we already say, in the format currently winning the algorithm.

Skipped, no genuine angle: the “Two Fishes” TikTok sound (Love Island reaction audio about not having to choose between two fish) — no non-forced retail tie without stretching, and the precise 2026 World Series start date (Oct 23) — already covered via the broader MLB postseason item on Oct 3; repeating it with one more date detail would be padding, not a new idea.

Compliance check: none of the above imply pricing, encourage overconsumption, or use underage-adjacent framing — #2 and #4 are security/tax compliance education, #1 and #6 repurpose existing buyer-education content, #3 is cost-planning framing, #5 is value-of-approach for Moolah Points without stating a specific offer.